NEPQ Phase 6 — Consequences

Cheat sheet · 5 Nov 2026 · light version

Purpose

Help the prospect see, honestly, what happens if **nothing changes**. Knowing the problem and picturing the fix often isn't enough; people put things off until it's a crisis. One calm look at the cost of waiting creates real urgency.

When to use it

Stage	Use it?
Discovery (your 20 conversations)	**No.** You want honest data, not urgency. Pressure gives you false yeses.
Offer (you have something to sell)	**Yes, lightly.** One or two questions after Commitment, before you present.

Do / Don't

Do	Don't
Ask one or two calm questions	Paint a doom scenario for them
Let them answer, then stay quiet	Fill the silence or pile on
Use their pain and their words	Invent risks they never mentioned
Accept "it can wait" as a real answer	Push past a genuine no

The questions (pick one or two)

Ask	What it does
"What happens if nothing changes over the next 6 months?"	Makes them face the cost of waiting
"Where does that leave you by next summer?"	Turns it into a concrete picture
"What have you missed out on because of it so far?"	Makes the cost real, using the past
"How would it feel to be in the same spot a year from now?"	The emotional side, in their own words

Why it works: the gap between their ideal (Phase 4) and "nothing changes" is what drives a decision. When **they** describe that gap, the urgency is theirs, not yours.

Applied to TRB: gym owners, offer stage only

Their pain	Light consequence question
Getting new members	"If January comes and goes with the same number of sign-ups, what does that mean for the year?"
Members leaving	"If people keep drifting off at the same rate, where does that leave you by summer?"
Admin eating their time	"If you're still doing this every Sunday night a year from now, how does that feel?"
Standing out from chains	"If the big gym down the road keeps showing up first, what happens to your numbers?"

Swap in whatever pain they actually gave you in Phase 3, in their own words.

Guardrail: protect your reputation

Milton Keynes is a small market and gym owners talk to each other. Being known as the honest guy who helped is worth more than one trial you pressured someone into. If it feels like a push, it is one, so stop.

Exercise for you (10 minutes)

Write your own consequence: *"If TRB never takes off, where am I a year from now?"* Feeling it yourself helps you understand why prospects avoid the question, and it is good fuel for you too.

Self-check after each call

☐ Did I only use it at the offer stage?

☐ Did I ask one or two questions, not a lecture?

☐ Did they describe the cost in their own words?

☐ Did I stay quiet and let it land?

☐ If they said "it can wait", did I respect that?

Next phase: Presentation, where you finally show your solution, matched to their pain and their ideal fix.